

SYSTEM SPECIFICATION

Startups Directory Field, Privacy and Publishing Specification

A structured specification for startup registration, profile completion, field visibility, public directory cards, admin review and investor readiness.

Document overview: Defines the minimum registration flow, post-login profile sections, public/private visibility rules, mandatory directory fields, admin review process and investor-readiness data.

Prepared for

P@SHA Startups & Entrepreneurship Committee

1. Purpose and Scope

The Startups Directory allows a founder to register quickly and complete the remaining profile after login. The system separates public directory information from private, admin-only and investor-only information.

Business goals

- Create a trusted national startup directory under P@SHA.
- Reduce registration friction with minimum fields.
- Let startups control visibility for sensitive data.
- Support featured startups, women-led filters, investors, partners and committee programs.

System scope

- Field-level visibility controls.
- Field metadata and profile completion levels.
- Admin review and verification workflow.
- Mandatory public fields for published directory profiles.

Profile completion approach: Registration remains short. Detailed business, traction, funding, market, competitor and document fields are completed after login from the startup dashboard.

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2. Roles and Visibility Model

The system must support public directory discovery while protecting founder contact details, documents, revenue, funding and admin review data.

User roles

- **Startup user:** creates and manages own startup profile.
- **Admin:** reviews, approves, rejects and verifies profiles.
- **Committee reviewer:** views submitted profiles and adds notes.
- **Investor user:** sees investor-only fields after approval.
- **Public visitor:** sees only public directory data.

Visibility options

- Public** Visible to all visitors.
- Private** Startup owner and authorized admin only.
- Admin Only** Internal P@SHA users only.
- Investors Only** Verified investors only after startup permission.

Visibility policy matrix

Field Type	Default Visibility	Can User Change?	Reason
Directory identifiers: startup name, city, sector, stage, one-line description	Public	No after publish	These are required for search, filters and startup cards.
Founder contact: email, phone, WhatsApp	Private	Yes, but explicit opt-in required	Protect founder privacy and prevent spam.
Business narrative: problem, solution, product features, USP	Public	Yes	Useful for directory profile; can be made private until review.
Market, competitors, traction, revenue and funding	Private or Investors Only	Yes	Can be sensitive and should not be public by default.
Documents: pitch deck, certificates, CNIC/passport, NTN	Private or Admin Only	Limited	Sensitive documents must not be public.
Admin notes, scores and review history	Admin Only	No	Internal review data must never leak to public APIs.

Default privacy principle: Any field that is not necessary for public directory discovery should be private unless the founder intentionally chooses public or investors-only visibility.

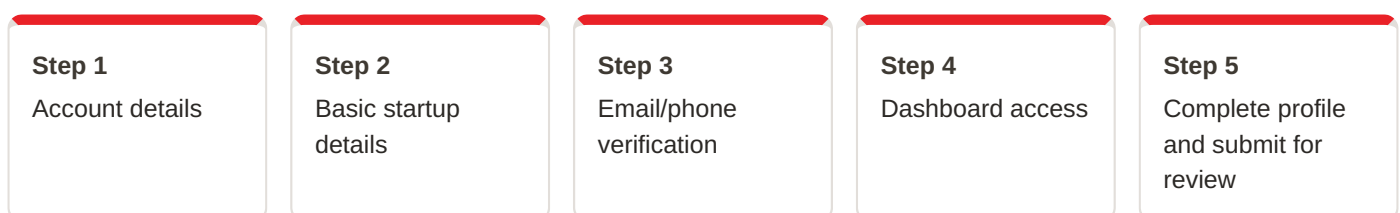
3. Minimum Registration Fields

Registration should collect only what is needed to create an account and a basic startup draft. Everything else should be completed after login.

Field	Input Type	Required Stage	Default Visibility	User Control	Implementation Notes
Founder / representative full name	Text	Registration	Private	No	Account owner name for admin review. Not shown publicly.
Email address	Email	Registration	Private	No	Unique login identifier. Verify with email OTP/link.
Mobile / WhatsApp number	Phone	Registration	Private	No	Verify by OTP. Used for account recovery and admin communication.
Password	Password	Registration	Private	No	Hash only. Enforce minimum policy and never store plain text.
Startup name	Text	Registration + Publishing	Public	No after publish	Shown on directory card and public profile. Must be unique enough for slug.
Country	Dropdown	Registration + Publishing	Public	No after publish	Default Pakistan, but allow international market startups if committee approves.
City	Dropdown	Registration + Publishing	Public	No after publish	Shown in filters and directory card.
Startup stage	Dropdown	Registration + Publishing	Public	No after publish	Shown in filters and directory card.
Industry / sector	Multi-select	Registration + Publishing	Public	No after publish	Ask for at least one sector. Used in filters.
One-line description	Text, max 160 chars	Registration + Publishing	Public	No after publish	Shown on directory card.
Terms, privacy and data usage agreement	Checkbox	Registration	Private	No	Record consent timestamp, IP and policy version.

Registration validation: Email and mobile number must be unique at account level. Startup name should be checked for duplicate slugs, but admin override should be available because similar startup names may exist.

Recommended registration screen sequence



4. Full Startup Profile Fields

After login, the founder should complete the startup identity, description, links and directory card assets. Public fields can appear on the startup profile after admin approval.

Field	Input Type	Required Stage	Default Visibility	User Control	Implementation Notes
Startup logo	Image upload	Publishing	Public	No after publish	Required for polished directory. Generate placeholder if missing.
Cover image	Image upload	Optional	Public	Yes	Used on profile page only.
Legal company name	Text	Optional	Private	Yes	Admin/investor use; user may choose public.
Year founded	Year	Publishing	Public	No after publish	Useful for discovery and maturity filters.
Detailed description	Long text	Publishing	Public	Yes	Full profile content. Default public but user can make private draft until submitted.
Website URL	URL	Optional	Public	Yes	Visible on profile if provided.
LinkedIn URL	URL	Optional	Public	Yes	Visible on profile if provided.
Facebook / Instagram / X / YouTube URLs	URL set	Optional	Public	Yes	Store as structured social links.
Public profile slug	System text	System	Public	No	Generated from startup name. Must remain public.
Public contact preference	Toggle / Enum	Optional	Public setting	Yes	Options: contact form only, show email, show phone, hide contact.

Developer instruction: Store file uploads separately from profile text fields. Each uploaded asset must have file type, owner, visibility, upload timestamp and virus-scan status.

5. Founder, Team and Contact Fields

Founder data should be useful for credibility and networking, but personal contact details must remain private by default.

Field	Input Type	Required Stage	Default Visibility	User Control	Implementation Notes
Primary founder name	Text	Publishing	Public	Yes	Public by default for credibility. User can hide on request except admin sees it.
Founder designation	Text	Publishing	Public	Yes	CEO, Founder, Co-founder, CTO, etc.
Founder LinkedIn	URL	Recommended	Public	Yes	Strongly recommended for investor-ready profiles.
Founder email	Email	Optional	Private	Yes	Private by default; public only when selected by the user.
Founder phone / WhatsApp	Phone	Optional	Private	Yes	Private by default; public only when selected by the user.
Founder gender	Dropdown	Optional	Private	Yes	Needed only for women-led tagging and analytics; never expose by default.
Founder bio	Long text	Optional	Public	Yes	Useful for profile page and investor view.
Co-founder records	Repeatable group	Optional	Public by default	Yes	Each co-founder has name, role, LinkedIn, email, phone and visibility settings.
Team size range	Dropdown	Publishing	Public	No after publish	Used in filters and directory profile.

Privacy rule: Email, phone and WhatsApp are never public by default. If the founder enables public contact, show a warning and prefer a contact form instead of exposing raw contact data.

6. Problem, Solution, Product and USP Fields

These fields answer what the startup does, why it matters and why it is different. They should be placed under the Business Profile section after login.

Field	Input Type	Required Stage	Default Visibility	User Control	Implementation Notes
What customer problem are you solving?	Long text	Profile completion	Public	Yes	Founder-friendly version of problem statement. Recommended max 1,200 chars.
How does your startup solve this problem?	Long text	Profile completion	Public	Yes	Solution statement; can appear on public profile.
Key product features	Multi-line / repeatable	Profile completion	Public	Yes	User can add multiple features. Public by default.
Product maturity	Dropdown	Optional	Public	Yes	Idea, prototype, MVP, live product, scaling, enterprise-ready.
USP / competitive advantage	Long text	Profile completion	Public	Yes	Important for discovery and featured startup selection.
Target customers	Multi-select	Optional	Public	Yes	Consumers, SMEs, enterprise, banks, schools, government, etc.
Sales / GTM channels	Multi-select	Optional	Private by default	Yes	Useful for evaluation; may be investor-only.
Demo video URL	URL	Optional	Public	Yes	Embedded in profile if provided.
App Store / Play Store URLs	URL set	Optional	Public	Yes	Visible on public profile if provided.
Product screenshots	Image upload	Optional	Public	Yes	Shown in profile gallery.

Founder-friendly labels

Original Concept	Recommended Form Label
Problem	What customer problem are you solving?
Solution	How does your startup solve this problem?
Product features	What are your key product features?
USP	What makes your startup different?
Target customers	Who are your primary customers?

7. Competition, Market Size and GTM Fields

Competitive and market sizing fields are valuable for investors and committee evaluation, but they can be sensitive. Keep them private or investor-only by default.

Field	Input Type	Required Stage	Default Visibility	User Control	Implementation Notes
Global competitors	Repeatable text/URL	Optional	Investors Only	Yes	Could be sensitive. Allow public/investor/private choice.
Pakistan competitors	Repeatable text/URL	Optional	Investors Only	Yes	Could be sensitive. Allow public/investor/private choice.
Competitor comparison notes	Long text	Optional	Private	Yes	Helps admin/committee evaluate differentiation.
TAM amount	Number + currency	Optional	Investors Only	Yes	Exact numbers are optional for early-stage startups.
SAM amount	Number + currency	Optional	Investors Only	Yes	Segment that startup can realistically serve.
SOM amount	Number + currency	Optional	Investors Only	Yes	Expected share over next 3-5 years.
Market sizing notes	Long text	Optional	Investors Only	Yes	Allow explanation and assumptions.
Source / reference link	URL	Optional	Investors Only	Yes	Reference report, public source or internal estimate.

TAM

Total market opportunity globally or regionally.

SAM

Serviceable available market the startup can realistically serve.

SOM

Serviceable obtainable market expected in the next 3-5 years.

8. Traction, Recognition and Funding Fields

Traction and funding fields should support investor discovery without forcing startups to reveal sensitive numbers publicly.

Field	Input Type	Required Stage	Default Visibility	User Control	Implementation Notes
Monthly active users	Number	Optional	Private	Yes	Can be shared with investors only.
Number of customers	Number	Optional	Private	Yes	Can be public for strong traction, but private by default.
Monthly revenue range	Dropdown	Optional	Private	Yes	Use ranges instead of exact numbers.
Annual revenue range	Dropdown	Optional	Private	Yes	Use ranges and allow prefer not to disclose.
Growth rate	Text/percentage	Optional	Private	Yes	May be investor-only.
Major clients	Text / repeatable	Optional	Private by default	Yes	Some clients may be confidential.
Partnerships	Text / repeatable	Optional	Public	Yes	Can support featured startup selection.
Awards and recognition	Text / repeatable	Optional	Public	Yes	Public credibility signal.
Media coverage links	URL set	Optional	Public	Yes	Public credibility signal.
Funding status	Dropdown	Optional	Public	Yes	Bootstrapped, angel-funded, VC-funded, grant-funded, etc.
Total funding raised	Range	Optional	Private	Yes	Use ranges; investor-only optional.
Currently fundraising	Yes/No	Optional	Public	Yes	Used for investor discovery badge.
Amount raising	Range	Optional	Investors Only	Yes	Shown only to approved investors if user allows.
Open to investor contact	Toggle	Optional	Public	Yes	Controls investor CTA.

Revenue and funding: Use ranges rather than exact values. Provide “Prefer not to disclose” where appropriate.

9. Operations, Collaboration and Women-led Fields

These fields power hiring filters, collaboration opportunities, committee programs, women-led startup discovery and partnership matching.

Field	Input Type	Required Stage	Default Visibility	User Control	Implementation Notes
Operating markets	Multi-select	Optional	Public	Yes	Pakistan, GCC, North America, EU, etc.
Office address	Text	Optional	Private	Yes	Private by default.
Remote / physical office	Dropdown	Optional	Public	Yes	Useful for partners and hiring.
Currently hiring	Yes/No	Optional	Public	Yes	Creates hiring badge/filter.
Open roles	Text / repeatable	Optional	Public	Yes	Show on profile if currently hiring.
Looking for mentors	Yes/No	Optional	Public	Yes	Used for collaboration filters.
Looking for partnerships	Yes/No	Optional	Public	Yes	Used for partner discovery.
Looking for corporate clients	Yes/No	Optional	Public	Yes	Used for B2B discovery.
Looking for government support	Yes/No	Optional	Public	Yes	Useful for committee programs.
Women-led startup	Yes/No	Optional	Public badge if yes	Yes	Show women-led badge only if user selects it.
Female founder/co-founder name	Text	Optional	Private by default	Yes	May be public if the person is already listed as founder and user chooses public.
Women ownership percentage	Range	Optional	Private	Yes	Analytics/admin only unless user chooses otherwise.

Women-led visibility: The women-led badge should appear publicly only when the startup explicitly selects it. Gender-level personal data must remain private unless the user chooses to show it.

10. Documents, Verification and Admin Fields

Document uploads and admin review fields must be protected. Public pages should only display derived trust badges such as Verified or Featured.

Field	Input Type	Required Stage	Default Visibility	User Control	Implementation Notes
Company registration certificate	File upload	Optional	Admin Only	No	Verification document. Admin-only; not public.
NTN / tax number	Text	Optional	Admin Only	No	Verification document. Admin-only; not public.
P@SHA membership number	Text	Optional	Admin Only	No	Used for member verification.
Founder CNIC / passport	File upload	Optional	Admin Only	No	Only if high-trust verification is required. Strong access controls.
Authorization letter	File upload	Optional	Admin Only	No	Useful when representative is not a founder.
Pitch deck	PDF upload	Optional	Private	Yes	Can be changed to investors-only by user. Never public by default.
Business profile	PDF upload	Optional	Private	Yes	Can be shared with investors or admin only.
Admin review notes	Long text	System	Admin Only	No	Internal comments only. Not exposed in frontend APIs.
Verification status	Enum	System	Public if verified	No	Pending, needs update, verified, rejected.
Featured startup status	Enum	System	Public if approved	No	Controls homepage and featured directory sections.

Admin status values

Draft
Submitted
Needs Update
Approved
Rejected
Verified
Featured

11. Mandatory Public Directory Fields

These fields are required for useful directory discovery. Once a profile is published, these fields remain visible and cannot be hidden by the startup user.

Field	Where Used	Visibility Rule	Required
Startup name	Directory card, search result, profile header	Always public	Required
Logo or generated placeholder	Directory card and profile header	Always public	Required before publish
One-line description	Directory card	Always public	Required
Industry / sector	Filters, search and card tags	Always public	Required
Startup stage	Filters and card tags	Always public	Required
City and country	Filters and geographic discovery	Always public	Required
Business model	Filters and discovery	Always public	Required before publish
Team size range	Startup maturity filter	Always public	Required before publish
Public profile URL / slug	Directory navigation	Always public	System
Verification badge	Trust signal	Public only if verified	System
Women-led badge	Homepage and filter	Public only if user opts in	Conditional
Hiring / fundraising / partnership badges	Directory CTA badges	Public only if user opts in	Optional

Directory card visible fields

- Logo or generated placeholder.
- Startup name and one-line description.
- City, country, sector and stage.
- Verified, featured, women-led, hiring or fundraising badges where applicable.
- View profile CTA.

Directory card hidden by default

- Founder email or phone.
- Revenue, funding amount or customer count.
- Pitch deck and verification documents.
- Office address and internal admin notes.
- Review score or committee comments.

12. Dashboard Workflow and Profile Completion

The dashboard guides founders step by step and shows whether each section is public, private, admin-only or investor-only.

Level	Completion	Requirement	System Benefit
Draft	25%	Account + minimum startup fields entered	Not public
Public Profile Ready	50%	Logo, description, industry, stage, business model and team size complete	Eligible for admin review
Business Profile Complete	75%	Problem, solution, features, USP, market and competitor sections complete	Better ranking and discovery
Featured Eligible	90%	Traction, awards, partnerships, women-led/hiring/fundraising badges complete where applicable	Can apply for featured section
Investor Ready	100%	Investor fields, pitch deck and contact preferences complete	Eligible for investor directory access

Dashboard modules

Complete Profile

Basic public details, logo, sector, description, city and stage.

Founder & Team

Founder data, co-founders, team size and contact preferences.

Business Profile

Problem, solution, product features, USP and GTM.

Investor Readiness

TAM/SAM/SOM, traction, funding, pitch deck and investor contact.

Programs & Badges

Women-led, featured startup, hiring, partnerships and events.

Review Status

Draft, submitted, needs update, approved, verified or featured.

Profile submission workflow

Status	Owner	Allowed Action	Public Visibility
Draft	Startup user	Edit all fields and visibility.	Not listed publicly.
Submitted	P@SHA admin	Review details, request update or approve.	Not listed until approved.
Needs Update	Startup user	Fix admin comments and resubmit.	Not listed or previous approved version remains.
Approved	System/Admin	Publish public profile.	Listed publicly.
Verified	P@SHA admin	Show verified badge.	Listed publicly with badge.
Featured	P@SHA admin	Show on home page and featured section.	Highlighted publicly.

13. Data Model, API and Validation

The data model needs to support new fields, visibility controls, profile completion levels, admin review and investor access without redesigning the database.

Suggested core entities

Entity	Purpose	Important Fields
users	Authentication and account ownership.	id, name, email, phone, password_hash, role, status, verified_at
startups	Main startup profile record.	id, owner_user_id, name, slug, stage, city, country, status, completion_score
startup_profile_fields	Flexible field values with visibility.	startup_id, field_key, value_json, visibility, updated_by, updated_at
founders	Founder and co-founder records.	startup_id, name, role, linkedin, email, phone, visibility settings
startup_files	Logo, pitch deck, screenshots and verification docs.	startup_id, file_type, path, visibility, uploaded_by, scan_status
reviews	Admin review and committee comments.	startup_id, reviewer_id, status, notes, reviewed_at
badges	Verified, women-led, featured, hiring, fundraising.	startup_id, badge_type, status, start_at, end_at
audit_logs	Privacy and admin action history.	actor_id, action, entity, old_value, new_value, ip, timestamp

Field metadata pattern

```
{
  "field_key": "problem_statement",
  "label": "What customer problem are you solving?",
  "section": "business_profile",
  "input_type": "long_text",
  "required_for_registration": false,
  "required_for_publishing": false,
  "required_for_completion_level": 75,
  "visibility_policy": "user_selectable",
  "default_visibility": "public",
  "allowed_visibility": ["public", "investors_only", "admin_only", "private"],
  "max_length": 1200,
  "is_searchable": true,
  "is_filterable": false
}
```

14. Enums, Dropdowns and Acceptance Criteria

Dropdowns are standardized so search, filters, analytics and admin reporting remain consistent.

Startup stages

Idea Stage Prototype MVP Early Revenue
Growth Stage Scaling Established

Business models

B2B B2C B2B2C SaaS Marketplace
Subscription Transaction-based

Team sizes

1-5 6-10 11-25 26-50 51-100 100+

Funding status

Bootstrapped Grant-funded Angel-funded VC-funded
Corporate-backed Not disclosed

Acceptance criteria for MVP

- Startup user can register with the minimum required fields only.
- Startup user can complete remaining profile fields after login.
- Each eligible field has visibility options: public, private, investors-only or admin-only.
- Mandatory directory fields cannot be hidden after publishing.
- Admin can approve, reject, request update, verify and feature a startup.
- Public directory cards hide email, phone, revenue, funding, pitch deck and verification documents by default.
- All visibility changes are stored in audit logs.
- Public API returns only fields allowed for the current viewer role.

15. Implementation Checklist

Use this checklist before handoff to frontend, backend and QA teams.

Frontend

- Registration form uses only minimum fields.
- Dashboard separates Basic Profile, Business Profile, Investor Readiness and Verification.
- Every user-selectable field has a clear visibility selector.
- Public/private help text is visible before submission.
- Directory card renders public fields only.

Backend

- Field metadata controls validation and visibility.
- APIs filter response fields by viewer role.
- Admin-only and private files have signed access only.
- Changes to sensitive fields are audited.
- Profile status and completion score are calculated server-side.

Admin

- Admin can verify documents and approve profiles.
- Admin can request updates with comments.
- Admin can apply verified, featured, women-led and other badges.
- Reviewer notes remain private.
- Published profile history is retained.

QA

- Test public visitor, startup user, admin and investor permissions.
- Test that hidden fields are excluded from frontend and API payloads.
- Test public directory card against mandatory fields.
- Test export and PDF layouts.
- Test mobile responsiveness for long forms and tables.